

Root Crops

Radish



HARVEST SEASONS
Spring / Summer / Autumn

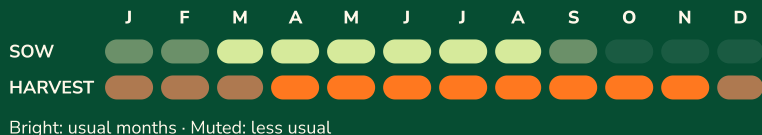


Radishes are among the fastest root crops and deserve a place for their speed alone: spring sowings can give mild, juicy roots when few other outdoor crops are ready. They are useful in odd corners, window boxes, under protection, or as a quick crop between slower vegetables. The familiar small red and red-white radishes are best eaten young, before heat, age or drought makes them hot, woody, hollow or soft. Winter radishes are a more substantial crop: they include white, pink, black and red-white types, grow for much longer, and can be grated, pickled, braised, stir-fried or stored in cool damp conditions after lifting in autumn.

Quick facts

Sow Mar – Aug	Harvest Apr – Nov	Germination 4–7 days	Depth Salad radishes: 1/2 in.; winter and oriental radishes: about 3/4 in.
Row spacing 6 in. between rows	Plant spacing Between plants: Salad 1–2 in.; winter/Japanese 6–8 in.	Yield (10 ft row) summer varieties: 4 lb; winter varieties: 10 lb	Ready in Salad 3–6; winter 10–12 weeks from sowing

Growing calendar



Core needs

1 = low · 5 = high

Sun	3/5
Water	4/5
Nutrition	2/5

Recommended varieties

SPRING/SUMMER

Rudolph

Round red radish for quick early sowings.

SPRING/SUMMER

Cherry Belle

Round, cherry-red roots.

SPRING/SUMMER

Long White Icicle

Long, white roots.

SPRING/SUMMER

Scarlet Globe

Globular, all-red.

SPRING/SUMMER

Prinz Rotin

Round, red summer radish.

SPRING/SUMMER

Sparkler

Round, red-and-white roots.

SPRING/SUMMER

Helro

Round, red roots.

SPRING/SUMMER

French Breakfast

Long red-and-white salad radish.

SPRING/SUMMER

Pink Beauty

Round, pink roots.

Key risks



Checked Growth / Poor Root Quality

Turnips, swedes and radishes need steady, quick growth.



FLEA BEETLE

Tiny beetles pepper seedling leaves with holes and can check young crops.



BOLTING

Winter radishes sown before July may flower before forming usable roots.



CABBAGE ROOT FLY

Late and winter radishes are often tunnelled by cabbage root fly maggots, especially after May sowings.

Growing & harvesting



Sun in spring; light shade in summer.

Hot, dry conditions make roots hotter and woodier.

Thin only where needed.

Pull the largest roots first and let smaller ones grow on.

Do not sow winter radishes too early.

They need to grow steadily into autumn, not bolt in summer.

Soil & preparation

1. Use rich, damp soil with a little compost and a fine tilth for rapid, tender growth.
2. Choose sun in spring and light shade in summer. Lime acid soil if needed; give winter radishes humus-rich drainage.

Sowing & planting

1 Sow salad radishes



Sow a short drill thinly and cover lightly. Repeat small sowings for succession.

2 Leave room to grow



Leave room between salad radishes; thin crowded seedlings.

Seed depth Salad radishes: 1/2 in.; winter and oriental radishes: about 3/4 in.

Salad rows 6 in. between rows

Winter rows 6 in. between rows

Salad plants Sow or thin to 1-2 in. apart.

Oriental plants Sow or thin to 6-8 in. apart, depending on variety.

Winter plants Sow or thin to 6-8 in. apart, depending on variety.

For a small patch, broadcast seed and rake it in. Winter radishes: sow in July or early August to reduce bolting.

Sow small batches every fortnight. Early sowings can go under cloches, glass or plastic; late-winter sowing is for favourable areas.

After May, cabbage root fly damage is more likely. Summer heat makes rapid growth harder to maintain.

Looking after the crop

1. Keep rows moist and weed-free. Quick, uninterrupted growth is the secret of crisp, mild radishes; water particularly as roots swell.
2. Thin only where needed. Pull the largest summer roots first, letting smaller ones grow on, but do not leave any too long.
3. Protect young leaves from flea beetle with fine mesh or fleece. Clear quick crops promptly for the next crop.

Harvesting & storage

- Pull spring and summer radishes while small, crisp and mildly flavoured. French Breakfast types are best before they become finger-thick and tough.
- Many spring varieties take 40-50 days; very quick crops may be ready in three to four weeks in good conditions. Pull surplus roots rather than leaving them to turn woody or hollow.
- Lift winter radishes in October or November before hard frost, or leave hardy kinds in the ground where frost is not severe. Store lifted roots cool and damp, for example in sand.

Pests & diseases

Problem	What to look for	What to do
FLEA BEETLE	Shot-holed leaves.	Keep moist; use fine mesh.
BOLTING	Early flowers; poor roots.	Sow winter radishes from July onwards.
CABBAGE ROOT FLY	Roots tunnelled by maggots.	Use mesh; trim minor root damage.
WOODY OR HOLLOW ROOTS	Hot, woody or hollow roots.	Water evenly; thin and harvest promptly.
ACID SOIL	Poor growth in acid soil.	Test soil; lime only where needed.
Slugs and Snails	Chewed seedlings; slime trails.	Check after dark; hand-pick around seedlings.

Final tips



Sow winter radishes in July or early August, not spring.



Clear quick crops promptly for the next crop.